

POISON-DART FROGS

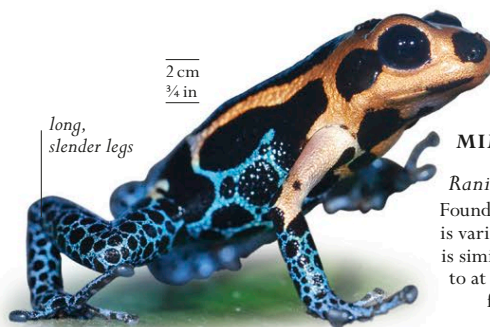
Called poison or poison-dart frogs, the Dendrobatidae are noted for their bright coloration. This warns predators that the skin of these frogs contains powerful toxins, which are derived from their insect prey. These frogs are found in the forests of Central and South America. They are active by day.



2.5–3.5 cm
1–1½ in

SPOTTED-THIGHED POISON-DART FROG
Allobates femoralis

The male of this S. American species guards the eggs laid by the female in leaf nests. Later, he carries the tadpoles to water on his back.



2 cm
¾ in

long,
slender legs

MIMIC POISON FROG
Ranitomeya imitator

Found in Peru, this frog is variable in colour and is similar in appearance to at least three other frog species.



1.8 cm
¾ in

DORIS SWANSON'S POISON-DART FROG
Andinobates dorisswansonae

Discovered in 2006, this species is found only in a fragment of forest in the Colombian Andes. It lives on the forest floor and on low-growing bromeliads.



2–2.5 cm
¾–1 in

LOVELY POISON-DART FROG
Phylllobates lugubris

This poisonous frog is found in leaf litter of lowland forests from Nicaragua to Panama. The male cares for the eggs and tadpoles.



3–4.5 cm
1¼–1¾ in

GOLDEN POISON FROG
Phylllobates terribilis

Possibly the most toxic of all poison-dart frogs, this terrestrial species occurs in lowland forests of Colombia.



1–2 cm
¾–¾ in

RAINFOREST ROCKET FROG
Silverstoneia flotator

This frog is found in Costa Rica and Panama. Its tadpoles have an upward-tilting mouth, which helps them feed from the water surface.



3.5–4.5 cm
1½–1¾ in

THREE-STRIPED POISON FROG
Ameerega trivittata

This S. American frog calls by day, especially after rain. It lays its eggs in leaf litter and is common near human settlements.



MARSUPIAL FROGS

Found in South and Central America, the Hemiphractidae carry their eggs on their back, where they hatch directly into froglets. Some also carry the eggs in a pouch, hence the name "marsupial frogs".



4.5–6.5 cm
1¾–2½ in

SUMACO HORNED TREEFROG
Hemiphractus proboscideus

This species is found in Colombia, Ecuador, and Peru. The female carries her eggs on her back, but does not have a pouch.

REED AND SEDGE FROGS

Also called African treefrogs, this large family, the Hyperoliidae, includes many agile climbers that gather in trees, bushes, or reeds near water to find mates and lay eggs. Some of the species are brightly coloured, with marked differences between the sexes.

RED-LEGGED KASSINA
Kassina maculosa

This is an aquatic E. African frog with adhesive discs on its toes. Its eggs, laid on submerged vegetation, hatch into large tadpoles.



prominent eyes

red patch
on leg

5.5–6.5 cm
2¼–2½ in



2.5–3.5 cm
1–1½ in

FOULASSI BANANA FROG
Afrixalus paradorsalis

Found in W. Africa, this frog lays its eggs in a folded leaf above water. The male attracts females with a click-like call.